

CHALLENGE STUDIO

Product Requirements Document & Developer Build Brief

A standalone SaaS platform and future Community Site module for building, launching, and operating transformational challenges.

Document	Detail
Prepared for	Robert Evans / Smartstack Platforms LLC
Primary implementation audience	Assigned developer using Claude Code
Version	1.0 - Product foundation
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Status	Approved concept; technical planning required before implementation
Product name	Challenge Studio

Core positioning

Challenge Studio is the complete challenge engine for creating 5-day launches, cohort experiences, evergreen challenges, paid journeys, and ongoing community transformation programs.

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1. How to Use This Document

This document is the product source of truth for the initial planning and build of Challenge Studio. It defines what the product is intended to become, which capabilities belong in the first release, how the major workflows should operate, and which technical boundaries must remain intact.

- The developer should first use this document to produce a written technical plan, architecture proposal, phased work breakdown, risk list, and questions requiring owner decisions.
- This document is not authorization to implement every future feature in one build. The MVP and later-roadmap boundaries are deliberate.
- Any proposed change that narrows the product vision, changes ownership, introduces third-party lock-in, or makes Community Site integration harder must be raised before implementation.
- Database schema concepts in this document are design guidance. Production database changes must be separately reviewed and approved before being applied.

First deliverable expected from the developer

A Claude-assisted build plan that maps this specification into milestones, architecture, routes, components, data entities, permissions, tests, deployment steps, and clearly identified owner decisions.

2. Executive Summary

Challenge Studio is a multi-tenant SaaS product that lets creators, coaches, authors, speakers, educators, ministries, businesses, agencies, and community leaders create structured challenge experiences. Those experiences may be short marketing events, paid programs, evergreen lead magnets, internal member-engagement campaigns, team challenges, or longer transformation journeys.

The core product insight is that a challenge is not simply a list of daily tasks. It is a guided transformation with a beginning state, a desired outcome, daily milestones, evidence of progress, community reinforcement, and a meaningful finish. Challenge Studio should therefore feel more like a journey and less like project-management software.

The standalone SaaS will provide its own creator accounts, workspaces, participants, public pages, challenge administration, communications, and analytics. Its architecture must also preserve a clean integration boundary so the same challenge engine can later operate as a paid add-on inside The Community Site, using Community Site identity, membership, branding, entitlements, and community capabilities where appropriate.

3. Product Vision and Strategic Purpose

3.1 Product vision

Challenge Studio helps leaders turn an idea, method, or desired outcome into an organized, motivating experience that people actually complete. It should make it possible to launch a polished challenge without assembling a patchwork of landing-page software, email tools, Facebook Groups, spreadsheets, Zoom links, course systems, and manual follow-up.

3.2 Strategic opportunity

- Replace the common Facebook Group plus email sequence approach used for 5-day marketing challenges.
- Give existing communities a repeatable way to create engagement, accountability, and visible progress.
- Allow creators to sell challenge-based experiences as standalone products.
- Create reusable challenge templates that may later be distributed through a marketplace.
- Become a flagship module within The Community Site ecosystem while remaining commercially viable as an independent SaaS.

3.3 Product promise

Product promise

Build a challenge. Guide a transformation. Turn participation into momentum, community, and measurable results.

3.4 Non-goals for the first release

- Challenge Studio is not initially a full learning-management system or replacement for every course platform.
- It is not initially a general CRM, full email-marketing platform, webinar platform, or payment processor.
- It should integrate with or provide focused versions of those capabilities only where they directly serve a challenge workflow.
- It should not attempt marketplace distribution, advanced AI generation, native mobile apps, complex affiliate management, or agency white labeling in the first MVP.

4. Target Customers and Use Cases

Customer	Representative uses	Primary value
Coaches and consultants	5-day launch, onboarding sprint, 30-day implementation journey	Lead conversion, program delivery, accountability
Authors	Book launch challenge, reading journey, writing sprint	Audience activation and deeper engagement
Speakers and thought leaders	Idea activation challenge, action week, event follow-up	Turn inspiration into action
Course and program leaders	Pre-course challenge, implementation sprint, graduation journey	Completion and outcomes
Community owners	Monthly engagement campaigns, member onboarding, habit challenges	Retention and daily participation
Fitness and wellness leaders	Movement, nutrition, mindfulness, wellness challenges	Habit tracking and social motivation
Ministries and churches	Prayer, scripture, service, generosity	Shared practice and testimony

	challenges	
Businesses and teams	Sales sprint, culture challenge, wellness initiative	Team performance and participation
Agencies	Build and manage challenge campaigns for clients	Repeatable client service
Local organizations and nonprofits	Fundraising, volunteer, awareness, local passport challenges	Mobilization and public participation

5. Product Principles

Principle	Meaning
Transformation before content	Every challenge should define where participants begin, where they are going, and how each step moves them forward.
Action before consumption	Daily experiences should prioritize doing, reflecting, sharing, and applying rather than merely watching content.
Community as an accelerator	Progress becomes more durable when people see others participate, receive encouragement, and contribute feedback.
Momentum must be visible	Participants should always understand their current day, progress, streak, next action, and upcoming milestone.
Simple creation, powerful configuration	A first-time creator should launch a basic challenge quickly, while advanced creators can configure cohorts, gates, rewards, and funnels.
Standalone first, integration-ready	The SaaS must work independently without embedding Community Site assumptions into its core domain model.
Mobile-first participation	The daily participant experience must be excellent on a phone, even if creator administration is best on desktop.
Owner-controlled data and brand	Creators should control their challenge content, participant data access, branding, and exports subject to the platform plan.

6. Product Scope and Challenge Modes

One challenge engine should support multiple operating modes. These are configurations of the same underlying product, not separate modules.

Mode	How it works	Common use
Marketing challenge	Registration campaign with public opt-in, scheduled content, engagement, live sessions, and a final offer	5-day lead-generation launch

Evergreen challenge	Each participant begins immediately or on their chosen date and advances on a personal schedule	Lead magnet or self-paced transformation
Cohort challenge	A defined group starts and progresses together on shared dates	Launch, mastermind, workshop, school, church
Internal community challenge	Restricted to members of an existing community or organization	Engagement and retention
Paid challenge	Enrollment requires purchase or an externally granted entitlement	Low-ticket product or premium experience
Team challenge	Participants belong to teams with shared scoring and team progress	Corporate, church, school, nonprofit
Habit challenge	Repeated activity with check-ins, streaks, and optional measurements	Wellness, writing, prayer, sales
Milestone journey	Steps may be sequential but not necessarily tied to calendar days	Onboarding or implementation roadmap

6.1 Challenge timing models

- Fixed calendar: all participants see the same active day.
- Rolling enrollment: each participant has an individual Day 1.
- Open access: all published days are available.
- Sequential completion: the next step unlocks after required completion.
- Scheduled release: days unlock at configured dates/times.
- Weekly release: groups of content unlock by week.

6.2 Challenge duration

The product must not hard-code common lengths. A creator may build a 3-day, 5-day, 7-day, 21-day, 30-day, 90-day, 365-day, or milestone-based experience. Presets may speed configuration, but the data model should support arbitrary durations and optional rest or catch-up days.

7. User Roles and Permissions

Role	Scope	Core permissions
Platform owner	Entire Challenge Studio SaaS	Plans, workspaces, support, moderation, system configuration, feature flags
Workspace owner	One creator/business workspace	Billing, branding, team access, all challenges, data exports
Workspace admin	Assigned workspace	Create and manage challenges, participants, content, analytics subject to permissions
Challenge manager	Selected challenges	Edit challenge, moderate participants, manage live sessions, view analytics
Facilitator / coach	Selected cohorts or groups	Comment, review submissions, give

		feedback, host sessions
Participant	Enrolled challenge	View allowed days, submit work, comment, track progress
Team captain	Participant team	Encourage team, view team progress, limited team administration
Public visitor	Public pages only	View registration/sales pages and register or purchase

7.1 Permission design requirement

Permissions must be capability-based rather than scattered role-name checks. The architecture should support explicit permissions such as challenge.create, challenge.publish, participant.manage, submission.review, analytics.view, billing.manage, and workspace.branding.manage.

8. End-to-End User Journeys

8.1 Creator launches a 5-day marketing challenge

34. Create a workspace or enter an existing workspace.
35. Choose Create Challenge and select the Marketing Challenge template.
36. Enter the promise, participant starting point, destination, title, summary, dates, timezone, and expected daily commitment.
37. Configure public registration, required form fields, consent language, welcome page, and challenge access.
38. Build five daily experiences and optional orientation and graduation days.
39. Add live-session details, replays, resources, homework requirements, discussion prompts, points, and reminders.
40. Configure the final offer, deadline, CTA, bonuses, and post-challenge access window.
41. Preview as a visitor and participant, send a test registration, and publish.
42. Promote the challenge using its public URL.
43. Monitor registrations, participation, submissions, attendance, completion, and offer clicks.

8.2 Participant joins and completes a marketing challenge

44. Visits a branded registration page and submits required details.
45. Receives confirmation and is directed to a welcome/orientation page.
46. Creates or confirms an account, accepts terms, and enters the challenge hub.
47. Sees the countdown or current day, schedule, community activity, and next action.
48. Completes each day, submits evidence or reflection, interacts with participants, and attends live sessions.
49. Receives progress celebrations, reminders, and catch-up guidance.
50. Completes the final day, receives a badge or certificate, and sees the creator's next-step offer.

8.3 Existing community owner launches an internal challenge

51. Installs or activates Challenge Studio for an eligible community site.
52. Creates a challenge using existing site branding and member identity.
53. Chooses which membership plans, groups, or selected members may join.
54. Publishes the challenge into community navigation and optionally announces it in the feed.
55. Members enroll without creating duplicate accounts and challenge activity can appear in a dedicated feed.

9. Creator Administration Experience

9.1 Workspace dashboard

- Active, draft, scheduled, completed, and archived challenges.
- Current participant counts, completion trends, upcoming sessions, and recent submissions.
- Primary Create Challenge action and template starting points.
- Workspace plan, usage, alerts, and onboarding checklist.

9.2 Challenge creation wizard

Step	Configuration
1. Foundation	Name, internal name, slug, promise, description, cover image, category, difficulty
2. Outcome	Starting state, desired outcome, success definition, expected commitment
3. Mode	Marketing, evergreen, cohort, internal, paid, team, habit, milestone
4. Schedule	Timezone, registration dates, start/end, rolling rules, unlock method, grace period
5. Audience	Public, invite-only, membership restriction, capacity, approval requirement
6. Experience	Days/steps, live sessions, community, submissions, gamification
7. Communications	Confirmation, reminders, daily notices, inactivity nudges, completion email
8. Conversion	Optional offer, CTA, deadline, tracking parameters
9. Review	Preview, validation checklist, test participant, publish

9.3 Challenge management navigation

- Overview
- Builder

- Participants
- Cohorts / teams
- Submissions
- Community
- Live sessions
- Communications
- Rewards
- Offer
- Analytics
- Settings
- Preview

9.4 Builder capabilities

Creators should be able to add, reorder, duplicate, draft, schedule, and preview challenge days or milestones. A day should be built from ordered content blocks. The builder must preserve a simple default path while supporting optional advanced blocks.

10. Participant Experience

10.1 Challenge hub

- Challenge title, promise, creator identity, cover image, and current status.
- Current day or milestone with a prominent Continue button.
- Progress percentage, completed steps, streak, XP, badges, and next milestone.
- Upcoming live session and calendar action.
- Recent challenge-feed activity and encouragement.
- Announcements, resources, and help information.

10.2 Daily challenge page

- Day number or milestone, headline, objective, estimated time, and completion requirements.
- Rich content blocks: video, audio, formatted lesson, images, quote, checklist, links, downloads, embed.
- Primary action assignment and submission interface.
- Reflection prompts and private journal fields where configured.
- Discussion prompt, comments, reactions, and facilitator feedback.
- Progress summary and clear Complete Day action.
- Locked-next-day state with unlock explanation.

10.3 Accessibility and mobile behavior

The participant journey must be designed mobile-first, keyboard accessible, readable at common zoom levels, and usable with screen readers. Videos require creator-provided captions or transcript support where possible. Progress, locked states, errors, and completion must not rely on color alone.

11. Challenge Content Model

Block type	Purpose	MVP status
Heading / text	Lesson, instructions, context	Required
Video	YouTube, Vimeo, or supported hosted source	Required
Audio	Audio lesson or guided practice	Later or simple URL embed
Image	Visual content	Required
Download	Workbook, PDF, worksheet	Required
Checklist	Multiple required or optional tasks	Required
Assignment	Primary action instruction	Required
Text response	Short or long response	Required
File upload	Image, document, optional video/audio	Required with file limits
Reflection	Private or shareable prompt responses	Required
Discussion prompt	Threaded participant interaction	Required
Quiz / poll	Knowledge or opinion check	Post-MVP
External embed	Supported embed allowlist	Post-MVP
AI coach	Contextual guided conversation	Future
Reward unlock	Bonus content, badge, coupon, link	Basic badge MVP; advanced later

11.1 Completion rules

- Manual completion permitted.
- Required checklist items must be completed.
- Required text response must be submitted.
- Required upload must be accepted.
- Facilitator approval may be required in a later phase.
- Minimum watch time should not be required in MVP unless reliably measurable.

12. Marketing Challenge Funnel

Marketing challenges require capabilities beyond daily content because their business purpose is registration, engagement, trust, and conversion.

Stage	Required experience
Registration page	Headline, promise, dates, host, benefits, agenda, testimonials, form, consent, FAQ, countdown
Confirmation	Successful registration, next steps, calendar, account creation, invite sharing
Welcome / orientation	Video, workbook, schedule, community norms,

	introduction prompt
Pre-challenge nurture	Optional scheduled messages and reminders
Daily delivery	Challenge day, email notification, live session, replay, assignment
Catch-up	Missed-day reminder and accessible prior content based on rules
Graduation	Completion celebration, certificate/badge, social sharing
Offer	Offer page or external CTA, deadline, bonuses, FAQ, conversion tracking
Post-challenge	Replay window, closing reminder, survey, nurture handoff

12.1 Lead data and consent

Registration should capture only configured fields and must preserve consent timestamps, source/UTM fields, and acceptance of applicable terms. Export and integration capabilities should respect privacy settings and workspace permissions.

12.2 Offer capability boundary

The MVP may support a configured CTA to an external checkout or sales page. Native product checkout and revenue attribution can be introduced only after billing ownership, Stripe architecture, taxes, refunds, and entitlement behavior are separately designed.

13. Community and Social Experience

13.1 Dedicated challenge feed

- Challenge-specific posts and completion events should remain separate from a general community feed by default.
- Creators may choose which automated activity events are visible.
- Participants can post text, images, and allowed attachments subject to moderation.
- Comments, replies, reactions, mentions, and facilitator highlighting should be supported progressively.

13.2 Submission visibility

Visibility	Behavior
Private	Only participant and authorized facilitators may view.
Group	Visible to members of the same team/cohort.
Challenge	Visible to all enrolled participants.
Public showcase	Explicit opt-in and creator approval required; later phase.

13.3 Moderation

- Hide or remove content
- Suspend participant from social participation
- Report content
- Pin or feature posts
- Disable comments on specific items
- Maintain audit records for moderation actions

14. Gamification and Progress

14.1 MVP progress system

- Completed days and percentage progress
- Configurable points for primary actions
- Current and best streak
- Basic badges at configured milestones
- Challenge leaderboard that may be disabled
- Completion celebration and certificate-ready completion record

14.2 Points model

A creator may use default point values or configure points per action. Points should be calculated from durable events rather than arbitrary counters so they can be audited and recalculated.

Action	Illustrative default
Complete day	100 XP
Submit required response	25 XP
Upload evidence	50 XP
Post to challenge feed	15 XP
Comment encouragement	5 XP with anti-abuse limits
Complete weekly milestone	250 XP
Complete challenge	1,000 XP

14.3 Streak rules

Streaks require an explicit definition per challenge: calendar-day completion, scheduled-day completion, or repeated habit check-in. Timezone and grace-window behavior must be deterministic. Streak freezes are a future enhancement, not an MVP requirement.

14.4 Leaderboard safeguards

- Leaderboards must be optional.
- Creators may display full names, first name plus last initial, or participant-chosen display names.

- Anti-abuse rules must prevent unlimited points from repetitive comments or reactions.
- A noncompetitive progress mode should be available for sensitive communities.

15. Communications and Notifications

Message	Trigger
Registration confirmation	Successful registration
Account / access setup	Registration requiring an account
Challenge starting soon	Configured lead time
Day available	Daily or milestone unlock
Live session reminder	Configured time before session
Inactivity nudge	No progress within configured interval
Submission feedback	Facilitator comment or review
Milestone earned	Badge or progress milestone
Challenge completion	Completion criteria met
Offer closing	Configured marketing deadline

15.1 MVP communications boundary

The MVP should use reliable transactional email for challenge-related messages. It does not need to become a complete broadcast email-marketing system. Creators should be able to enable/disable core message types and edit a controlled set of subject/body fields with safe template variables.

15.2 Notification preferences

Participants must be able to manage nonessential challenge email preferences while still receiving security, access, and legally required messages. Workspace unsubscribe behavior should not accidentally unsubscribe a person from unrelated products or workspaces.

16. Live Sessions and Events

- Creators can schedule zero or more live sessions with title, date/time, timezone, description, host, join URL, and replay URL.
- Participants see sessions in the challenge hub and relevant daily pages.
- Calendar-file download should be supported in MVP if feasible.
- Zoom OAuth, native meeting creation, attendance sync, and automated replay ingestion are later integrations.
- External join URLs must be protected from public discovery when the challenge is private.

17. Analytics and Reporting

17.1 Creator dashboard metrics

- Registrations and enrollment trend
- Activation: registered participants who entered the challenge
- Day-by-day reach and completion
- Overall challenge completion rate
- Average days completed
- Submission rate
- Community participation rate
- Live-session clicks or attendance when known
- Offer clicks and configured conversion events
- Participant inactivity and at-risk list

17.2 Participant-level reporting

Authorized creators and facilitators should be able to view each participant's enrollment status, last activity, progress, submissions, points, streak, badges, and communication history. Sensitive private reflections must be clearly identified and permission-limited.

17.3 Export

Workspace owners should be able to export participant and progress data in a common format. Exports must be permission-checked, logged, and designed to avoid unintentionally exposing private submission content.

18. Branding and White Label

18.1 Workspace branding

- Workspace name, logo, icon/favicon, primary color, accent color, text contrast validation, support contact, legal links, and default sender identity.
- Optional custom domain and platform-branding removal should be plan-controlled later.
- Challenge-level branding may override cover image, visual theme, and selected colors while preserving accessibility.

18.2 Public-page branding

Registration, welcome, login, challenge hub, and offer pages should look like one continuous branded experience. The design must avoid a generic admin-template feel and emphasize momentum, transformation, and human connection.

19. Standalone SaaS Requirements

- Multi-tenant workspaces with strict tenant isolation.
- Authentication and account recovery.

- Workspace invitations and role assignment.
- Plan/entitlement-ready architecture even if billing is not activated in the first internal build.
- Public challenge URLs with durable slugs and canonical host handling.
- Reliable file storage with workspace/challenge ownership metadata.
- Transactional email provider abstraction.
- Basic support/admin visibility for the platform owner.
- Vercel deployment and environment separation for development, preview, and production.
- Logging, error monitoring, and auditability for critical actions.

19.1 Suggested initial stack

The expected implementation direction is a modern Next.js application deployed to Vercel, with TypeScript, a relational database, secure object storage, and a server-side authorization layer. The developer should propose exact versions and supporting libraries based on maintainability, security, and compatibility rather than novelty.

19.2 Billing readiness

The domain model should be ready for future workspace subscriptions and usage limits, but production billing should not be activated until products, prices, entitlements, lifecycle states, cancellation, failed-payment handling, and webhook idempotency are separately approved.

20. The Community Site Module Integration

The Community Site treats paid modules as independent products. Challenge Studio must be designed so it can be licensed and activated for eligible Community Site tenants without merging its internal domain logic into unrelated native features.

20.1 Integration goals

- Use Community Site member identity through a secure trusted integration rather than requiring duplicate accounts.
- Resolve a Community Site tenant to a Challenge Studio workspace or integration installation.
- Inherit site branding by default while allowing challenge-level presentation settings.
- Restrict access based on Community Site site entitlements, module license status, membership, group, or offer access.
- Expose challenge navigation and participant experiences inside the community shell or through a seamless module route.
- Allow selected challenge events to appear in Community Site feeds and notifications without duplicating all social data.
- Provide installation, deactivation, grace-period, and data-export behavior.

20.2 Integration boundary

Concern	System of record
Community site, domain, plan, module activation	The Community Site
Challenge definition, days, progress, submissions, challenge analytics	Challenge Studio
Community member identity	The Community Site when embedded; Challenge Studio when standalone
Standalone workspace billing	Challenge Studio
Community Site module billing/license	The Community Site module system
Tenant member purchases	Community Site/tenant commerce when integrated
Challenge files	Challenge Studio or agreed shared storage with explicit ownership

20.3 Entitlement principle

Integration code must check explicit module and feature entitlements, not assume access based only on plan names. The Community Site strategy allows eligible Community and Creator Core sites to purchase modules, while module compatibility may vary by required native capabilities.

20.4 API and identity approach

The developer should propose a signed server-to-server installation and launch model. Browser-supplied site IDs or role claims must never be trusted without server validation. The integration should support token expiry, replay protection, tenant binding, user binding, and revocation.

21. Conceptual Data Model

The following entities express product concepts. They are not an approved migration script and should be refined by the developer before database work.

Entity	Purpose	Important relationships
users	Standalone identities and platform users	Memberships, enrollments, submissions
workspaces	Tenant/business container	Challenges, team members, branding, plan
workspace_memberships	Workspace roles and status	User + workspace + permissions
integrations / installations	External system connection such as Community Site	Workspace, external tenant, license status
challenges	Primary challenge definition	Workspace, creator, status, mode, schedule
challenge_steps	Ordered day or milestone	Challenge, content blocks, unlock rules
content_blocks	Ordered content within a step	Step, block type, structured payload

cohorts	Shared schedule/enrollment group	Challenge, participants, schedule override
teams	Participant team	Challenge/cohort, memberships, score
enrollments	Participant access and lifecycle	Challenge, user/participant, cohort, status
step_progress	Per-participant step state	Enrollment, step, completion timestamps
submissions	Responses and uploaded evidence	Enrollment, step, visibility, review
comments / reactions	Social interaction	Challenge, step, submission or feed post
feed_events	Durable challenge activity	Challenge, actor, event type, visibility
points_events	Auditable point awards/reversals	Enrollment, action source, amount
badges / badge_awards	Milestones and earned rewards	Challenge/workspace + enrollment
live_sessions	Scheduled live events	Challenge or step
message_templates	Configurable transactional messages	Workspace/challenge + trigger
message_deliveries	Delivery and failure log	Recipient, trigger, provider status
offers	Configured final CTA or future native offer	Challenge, visibility, deadline
analytics_events	Product and funnel events	Workspace, challenge, enrollment, session
audit_logs	Critical administrative actions	Actor, workspace, object, before/after metadata

21.1 Data requirements

- Every tenant-owned record must carry a reliable tenant/workspace relationship.
- External integration IDs must be namespaced by provider and tenant.
- Progress and points should be event-driven or reproducible where practical.
- Dates must be stored consistently with challenge timezone retained separately.
- Soft deletion or archival behavior must be deliberate for challenges with participant history.
- Uploads require ownership, access policy, media type, size, scan/status, and deletion handling.

22. Application Architecture and API Boundaries

22.1 Recommended domain separation

Domain	Responsibility
Identity and access	Authentication, sessions, workspace membership,

	authorization
Challenge authoring	Challenge configuration, step builder, validation, publishing
Enrollment and scheduling	Registration, cohort assignment, unlock calculation
Participation	Progress, submissions, reflections, completion
Community	Posts, comments, reactions, moderation, feed events
Gamification	Points events, streaks, badges, leaderboards
Communications	Templates, trigger evaluation, delivery, preferences
Analytics	Event collection, aggregates, dashboards, exports
Integrations	Community Site, email, storage, video, calendar, future Stripe/Zoom
Platform operations	Plans, feature flags, support tooling, audit logs

22.2 API design expectations

- Server-side authorization on every protected operation.
- Idempotent endpoints or actions for registration, completion, point awarding, and webhook processing.
- Versioned integration contracts for Community Site.
- Validation of structured content-block payloads.
- Rate limits and abuse controls on public registration and social actions.
- No database service-role or secret credentials exposed to browser code.
- Clear separation between public read models and privileged creator/admin operations.

22.3 Publishing model

A challenge should support draft, scheduled, published, closed, completed, and archived states. Publishing should validate required fields, schedule consistency, at least one step, public page requirements when registration is enabled, and test whether referenced files/resources exist.

23. Security, Privacy, and Operational Requirements

- Strict workspace and challenge authorization with server-enforced tenant isolation.
- Secure account/session handling and protection against common web vulnerabilities.
- Signed and validated integration launch tokens.
- Public-form spam protection and configurable registration approval.
- Consent capture, privacy links, data export, and deletion workflow planning.
- File type and size limits; malware-scanning strategy should be considered before broad uploads.
- Private reflections and submissions must have explicit visibility and never leak into public feeds.
- Audit logs for role changes, exports, challenge publication, moderation, and integration changes.
- Secrets managed only through environment configuration and never committed.

- Error monitoring without logging sensitive submission content or authentication secrets.
- Backups and recovery expectations defined before production launch.

23.1 Special caution for sensitive niches

Challenge Studio may be used for wellness, relationships, faith, recovery, or other sensitive topics. The product should not position itself as medical, legal, or crisis care. Creators must remain responsible for their content, and the platform should provide terms, reporting, moderation, and emergency-resource boundaries where appropriate.

24. MVP Definition

The MVP should prove that a creator can build and launch a polished challenge and that participants can register, progress, submit, interact, and complete it. It should not attempt the complete long-term vision.

Area	MVP requirement
Auth/workspace	Accounts, workspace, owner/admin roles, invitations
Branding	Logo, icon, colors, workspace name, challenge cover
Challenge setup	Create/edit/archive, mode, dates, timezone, visibility, arbitrary length
Builder	Ordered steps with text, video link/embed, image, download, checklist, assignment, response, upload, reflection, discussion
Publishing	Draft, preview, validation, publish, close
Public funnel	Registration page, confirmation, welcome/orientation
Enrollment	Public and invite-only, account linking, participant list
Participation	Challenge hub, daily page, progress, completion, locked/unlocked rules
Social	Dedicated feed or step discussion, comments, reactions, basic moderation
Gamification	Points, simple streak, milestone badges, optional leaderboard
Live sessions	Manual session records and join/replay links
Email	Confirmation, start, daily unlock, live reminder, inactivity, completion
Analytics	Registrations, activation, daily completion, overall completion, participant detail
Offer	Configurable external CTA after final day
Operations	Audit basics, error monitoring, responsive UI, Vercel deployment

24.1 Recommended MVP scenario

Primary acceptance scenario

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A coach can create a branded 5-day cohort marketing challenge, publish a registration page, enroll participants, deliver five scheduled daily experiences with homework and discussion, host linked live sessions, view progress, celebrate completion, and direct finishers to an external paid offer.

24.2 Explicitly deferred from MVP

- AI challenge generation and AI coach
- Native payments and checkout
- Template marketplace
- Advanced certificates
- Zoom OAuth and automated attendance
- SMS and mobile push
- Native mobile apps
- Agency client management
- Custom domains unless unusually simple within the chosen architecture
- Advanced quizzes, conditional branching, and workflow automation
- Public API for third-party developers
- Full Community Site embedded integration; build the integration boundary and plan first

25. Post-MVP Roadmap

Phase	Theme	Capabilities
Phase 2	Professional launch tools	Advanced registration pages, native offer tracking, cohorts, teams, improved communications, certificates
Phase 3	AI and templates	AI challenge builder, AI feedback, template library, cloning, imports
Phase 4	Community Site integration	Module activation, shared identity, entitlements, community navigation/feed integration
Phase 5	Commerce and marketplace	Native paid challenges, template marketplace, licensing and revenue reporting
Phase 6	Agency and scale	Client workspaces, reusable brand kits, agency controls, white-label options, API
Phase 7	Mobile and ecosystem	Native apps, push notifications, external integrations, developer platform

26. Page and Route Inventory

Surface	Pages / screens
Platform marketing	Home, features, use cases, pricing, examples, login, signup, legal
Authentication	Signup, login, verify, forgot/reset password, accept invitation
Workspace	Dashboard, onboarding, branding, team, integrations, billing placeholder, settings
Challenges	List, create wizard, overview, builder, participants, cohorts, teams, submissions, community, live sessions, communications, rewards, offer, analytics, settings, preview
Public challenge	Registration, confirmation, welcome, login/access, challenge home, day/step, feed, leaderboard, resources, live session, completion, offer
Participant account	My challenges, profile, preferences, notifications, certificates/badges later
Platform admin	Workspaces, users, challenges, flags, support view, audit, system status
Integration	Install/authorize, launch callback, health/status, deactivation/data export later

26.1 Route naming

The developer should propose route conventions that cleanly separate platform marketing, authenticated creator administration, public challenge pages, participant pages, and integration callbacks. Slugs must be validated, reserved names protected, and tenant resolution explicit.

27. Acceptance Criteria

Area	Acceptance criterion
Creator onboarding	A new owner can create a workspace, configure basic branding, and reach the challenge dashboard without manual database intervention.
Challenge creation	A creator can build a five-step challenge, reorder steps, configure schedule and visibility, preview it, and publish only when validation passes.
Registration	A public visitor can register once, receive confirmation, create/access an account, and become enrolled without duplicate active enrollments.
Scheduling	The correct day is unlocked based on challenge/cohort timezone and configured release rules.
Participation	An enrolled participant can consume content, submit required work, complete a day, and see accurate progress.
Privacy	Private submissions cannot be accessed by unrelated

	participants or workspaces.
Community	Participants can comment/reply/react where enabled; moderators can remove content.
Gamification	Eligible actions create auditable points and update progress without double-awarding on retries.
Email	Core transactional triggers are sent once, delivery failures are observable, and unsubscribe rules are respected.
Analytics	Creator totals match the underlying registrations, enrollments, and completion records.
Mobile	The complete participant flow works on common mobile viewport sizes.
Deployment	Preview and production deployments use separate configuration and do not expose secrets.

28. Testing and Quality Plan

- Unit tests for schedule/unlock calculations, progress calculation, point idempotency, permission decisions, and validation schemas.
- Integration tests for registration, enrollment, challenge publication, step completion, uploads, messaging triggers, and tenant isolation.
- End-to-end tests for creator build/publish and participant register/complete flows.
- Permission matrix tests across owner, admin, manager, facilitator, participant, and public visitor.
- Cross-tenant security tests ensuring identifiers cannot be used to access another workspace.
- Responsive UI testing for mobile participant screens and desktop creator screens.
- Accessibility checks for forms, navigation, focus, contrast, labels, errors, and progress states.
- Failure testing for email provider errors, storage failures, duplicate requests, expired tokens, and invalid schedules.
- Production smoke checklist after each deployment.

29. Implementation Workstreams

Workstream	Output
A. Product and UX foundation	Information architecture, user flows, low-fidelity screen plans, design tokens
B. Project foundation	Repository, Next.js setup, environments, linting, tests, deployment pipeline
C. Identity and tenancy	Auth, workspaces, memberships, authorization utilities
D. Challenge domain	Challenge/step models, builder, lifecycle, scheduling
E. Public funnel	Registration, confirmation, welcome, enrollment
F. Participant experience	Hub, step view, progress, completion, uploads
G. Community and gamification	Discussion/feed, comments, points, streaks, badges
H. Communications	Templates, triggers, delivery records, preferences

I. Analytics and operations	Dashboards, exports, audit, monitoring
J. Integration readiness	Installation model, signed launch contract, Community Site mapping plan
K. Hardening and release	Security review, accessibility, E2E tests, documentation, production checklist

29.1 Milestone discipline

Each workstream should be broken into reviewable milestones that can be demonstrated through the deployed preview environment. The developer should avoid one large unreviewable build. Every milestone should state user-visible outcomes, schema dependencies, tests, deployment changes, and owner decisions.

30. Developer Guardrails and Ownership

- The Challenge Studio concept, product name, specifications, source code created under this engagement, accounts, repositories, deployments, data models, designs, and related software assets are owned by Robert Evans / the designated Smartstack entity, subject to the parties' written agreement.
- Development must occur only in repositories, Vercel projects, databases, domains, and service accounts provided or approved by the owner.
- Do not place production infrastructure, credentials, domains, or source code solely under a personal developer account.
- Do not introduce paid third-party services, restrictive licenses, or significant recurring costs without approval.
- Do not implement or apply production database migrations without a separate reviewed database plan and explicit approval. Prepare schema proposals and migration files for review.
- Do not modify The Community Site repository or database as part of the standalone build unless a separate integration stage is explicitly authorized.
- Keep secrets out of code and commit history. Use environment variables and document every required variable.
- Document architecture, setup, deployment, schema, APIs, operational procedures, and known limitations throughout the build.
- Use branches and small, understandable commits. Preserve a demonstrable deployed preview for review.
- Raise ambiguity rather than silently choosing a direction that changes product scope, access, billing, or data ownership.

31. Claude Code Planning Prompt

The developer may paste the following instruction into Claude Code along with this document:

Planning prompt

Review the attached Challenge Studio Product Requirements Document as the product source of truth. Do not begin implementation yet. Produce a detailed technical build plan for a standalone multi-tenant SaaS deployed on Vercel and designed for later integration as a paid module within The Community Site. Include: architecture, proposed stack and versions, repository structure, route map, component plan, conceptual schema, authorization model, challenge scheduling logic, integration boundaries, file-storage approach, email architecture, analytics event model, security risks, test strategy, milestone plan, deployment plan, environment variables, owner decisions, and features explicitly excluded from MVP. Identify conflicts, hidden complexity, and any assumptions. Database changes must be proposed separately and must not be applied until explicitly approved. Prefer incremental milestones that each produce a demonstrable result in a preview deployment.

31.1 Expected output from Claude Code

- Architecture decision record with alternatives considered.
- MVP milestone sequence with acceptance criteria.
- Proposed schema diagram or entity list, without applying migrations.
- Route and component inventory.
- Authorization and tenant-isolation plan.
- Scheduling/unlock algorithm specification including timezone edge cases.
- Integration contract proposal for future Community Site use.
- Risks, open decisions, and estimates expressed as relative complexity rather than unsupported promises.
- First milestone implementation prompt only after the plan is reviewed and approved.

32. Open Decisions and Assumptions

Decision	Current assumption for planning
Standalone domain	A Challenge Studio branded domain will be acquired; exact domain is not yet fixed.
Initial pricing	Not decided; architecture should be entitlement-ready but billing is not an MVP prerequisite.
Database/provider	Developer should propose based on owner stack preference and future integration; no production migration without approval.
Email provider	Use an abstraction; Resend is a likely option but requires approval/configuration.
File storage	Use secure object storage with signed access and tenant ownership.
Video hosting	MVP uses supported external links/embeds rather than becoming a video host.
Community Site integration timing	Architecture-ready now; full integration after standalone MVP is validated.
AI features	Deferred until core workflows and data model are stable.

Native checkout	Deferred; external CTA initially.
Custom domains	Desirable but may be deferred from MVP.

Any unresolved item should be surfaced in the technical plan. Lack of a decision is not permission to permanently hard-code an assumption.

33. Final Handoff Checklist

- Developer has access to the owner-controlled Git repository.
- Developer has appropriate Vercel team/project access, not ownership outside the owner account.
- Development and preview environments are created with separate secrets.
- This PRD is stored in the repository under a docs or product folder.
- Developer has produced and received approval on the technical build plan.
- Database proposal has been reviewed separately before migrations are applied.
- Milestone 1 has a defined demonstration and acceptance criteria.
- All external services and costs are documented and approved.
- Ownership, compensation, revenue-share, confidentiality, and post-engagement access are covered in a separate written agreement.
- The owner can independently access the repository, deployments, database, domains, logs, and service accounts at all times.

Closing Product Statement

Challenge Studio should make it possible for a leader to turn a promise of change into a complete, motivating, community-powered experience. Its first release succeeds when one creator can run a professional 5-day marketing challenge without relying on a Facebook Group, while the same engine is clearly capable of powering ongoing community challenges, paid journeys, team initiatives, and future Community Site installations.

North star

Challenge Studio does not merely distribute daily content. It creates visible momentum toward a meaningful outcome.